Returns and Refunds

Our return window

You can return a complete e-bike or an accessory within **30 days of delivery**. For in-store pickups the 30 days start on the pickup date. Requests submitted on day 31 or later can't be accepted, but the item may still be covered by the warranty if something is defective.

We know a bike only proves itself on the road, so you're welcome to ride it during the window. To keep a return eligible, the bike must have fewer than **50 miles (80 km)** on the odometer. You can check the total distance on the NW-D3 display by holding the mode button for 3 seconds until "ODO" appears.

Condition requirements

To be accepted, a returned bike must:

- Have no crash damage, bent parts or deep scratches through the paint.
- Include the battery, charger, keys (both copies), pedals, manual and the reflector kit.
- Not have had parts swapped or accessories drilled into the frame.
- Be clean. A bike returned caked in mud is cleaned for a $35 fee deducted from the refund.

Accessories must be unused and in their original packaging with all tags attached.

Restocking fees

- **Complete e-bikes:** a **15%** restocking fee applies to bikes that were assembled and ridden. Bikes returned unopened in the original sealed box have no restocking fee.
- **Accessories:** no restocking fee if unopened. Opened but unused accessories carry a 10% fee.
- **Defective or wrong item shipped:** no fee at all. We also cover return shipping.

How to start a return

1. Sign in at northwindcycles.example.com/account and open **Orders**.
2. Choose the item and select **Start a return**. Pick a reason from the list.
3. For bikes, choose a freight pickup window. Return freight is a flat **$129**, deducted from your refund (waived for defects or our mistakes).
4. Repack the bike in its original box if you still have it. If you don't, we can send a replacement bike box for $25.
5. Accessories ship back with a prepaid label we email you; the label cost of $7.95 is deducted from the refund.

You'll get a return authorization number starting with **RA-**. Write it on the outside of the box. Packages that arrive without an RA number may be delayed by up to two weeks.

Inspection and refund timelines

Once your return reaches our warehouse, we inspect it within **5 business days**. After it passes inspection, the refund is issued to the original payment method. How quickly you see the money depends on how you paid:

Payment method	When the refund appears
Credit or debit card	5-7 business days after inspection
Digital wallet	3-5 business days after inspection
Brightrail Finance plan	Up to 10 business days; the loan balance is reduced first
Northwind gift card	Instantly, as store credit
Bank transfer (fleet orders)	7-10 business days

If you paid with a mix of methods, the gift card portion is refunded as store credit and the rest goes back to the card.

Items that can't be returned

The following are final sale:

- Standalone replacement batteries once removed from their sealed shipping bag. Lithium packs can't be resold after they leave our control.
- Custom builds, including bikes with a non-standard frame color or a changed drivetrain.
- Clearance items marked "Final Sale" on the product page.
- Gift cards and Northwind store credit.
- Service labor and tune-up packages that have been used.
- Helmets that have been worn, for hygiene and safety reasons.

Exchanges

We don't process direct exchanges. If you want a different size or model, return the original item and place a new order. If you place the new order within the 30-day window and mention your RA number in the order notes, we waive the $129 return freight.

Price adjustments

If the price of a bike you bought drops within **14 days** of delivery, contact us and we'll refund the difference as the original payment. Price adjustments don't apply to flash sales lasting under 24 hours or to open-box units.

Questions

Email returns@northwindcycles.example.com or call (555) 010-0137. Please have your order number (it begins with **NW-** followed by six digits) ready.